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# ENGLISH LANGUAGE STANDARD SEVEN

## Primary School Leaving Examination (PSLE) 2023 Answer Key and Worked Solutions

|                   |                                           |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| <b>Subject</b>    | English Language                          |
| <b>Code</b>       | 02                                        |
| <b>Level</b>      | Standard Seven                            |
| <b>Year</b>       | 2023                                      |
| <b>Exam Board</b> | NECTA                                     |
| <b>Exam</b>       | Primary School Leaving Examination (PSLE) |
| <b>Type</b>       | Answer key and worked solutions           |
| <b>Questions</b>  | 45 questions                              |

Try each question before checking the solution. Follow the steps, compare your working, and practise the parts you find difficult.

Source paper: English-S7-2023.pdf

## Section A — Listening

### 1. According to the listening passage, when did education begin?

**Step 1:** The passage places learning at the beginning of human life, before books or formal schools.

**Step 2:** Select the earliest event named in the options.

**Final Answer: B — When human beings were created.**

### 2. What helps a person become self-reliant and self-aware?

**Step 1:** Identify the tool linked to independence and awareness in the passage.

**Step 2:** The answer is the state of having received education.

**Final Answer: D — Educated.**

### 3. What two categories of education are described?

**Step 1:** Separate learning through ordinary family life from structured schooling.

**Step 2:** The passage contrasts these two kinds rather than individual activities.

**Final Answer: C — Formal and informal.**

### 4. What education should young people receive to create well-educated citizens?

**Step 1:** The question seeks the broad preparation described in the passage.

**Step 2:** Include learning both inside and outside formal institutions.

**Final Answer: D — Both formal and informal education.**

### 5. What basic benefit did formal education bring?

**Step 1:** Recall the three elementary skills named for the new schooling.

**Step 2:** They concern literacy and numeracy.

**Final Answer: A — Reading, writing and counting.**

Section Summary: Record the main idea and key contrasts while listening. Answer from the passage, rather than guessing from an option that sounds reasonable.

## Section A — Grammar and vocabulary

**6. I \_\_\_ practise cooking next Saturday.**

**Step 1:** Next Saturday refers to the future.

**Step 2:** Use will + base verb to express the planned future action.

**Final Answer: E — will.**

**7. He used to \_\_\_ sports programmes.**

**Step 1:** Used to is followed by the base form of a verb.

**Step 2:** The required base form is watch.

**Final Answer: C — watch.**

**8. The train \_\_\_ late three times this week.**

**Step 1:** This week is an unfinished period, so the present perfect fits repeated events.

**Step 2:** The train is singular: use has + past participle been.

**Final Answer: C — has been.**

**9. Mussa and Abdul \_\_\_ tennis now.**

**Step 1:** Now indicates an action in progress.

**Step 2:** With a plural subject, use are + playing.

**Final Answer: A — are playing.**

**10. Our former teacher \_\_\_ us happy during his classes.**

**Step 1:** The account concerns a former teacher's past behaviour.

**Step 2:** The simple past of keep is kept.

**Final Answer: D — kept.**

**11. Rajabu and Paul were mopping \_\_\_ their sister was washing dishes.**

**Step 1:** The two activities happened at the same time.

**Step 2:** While links simultaneous actions.

**Final Answer: B — while.**

**12. Janeth went to school \_\_\_ foot.**

**Step 1:** The fixed expression for walking as transport is on foot.

**Step 2:** By is used with many vehicles, but not in this expression.

**Final Answer: D — on.**

**13. Bats are more active \_\_\_ night.**

**Step 1:** The standard expression is at night.

**Step 2:** Use at for this time phrase.

**Final Answer: B — at.**

**14. The man was sentenced to two years \_\_\_ jail.**

**Step 1:** The sentence describes being inside prison.

**Step 2:** The established phrase is in jail.

**Final Answer: D — in.**

**15. The thief jumped \_\_\_ the gate.**

**Step 1:** The movement goes across the top of an obstacle.

**Step 2:** Over expresses that crossing.

**Final Answer: B — over.**

**16. The beast was not only ugly \_\_\_ dirty.**

**Step 1:** Complete the paired structure not only ... but also.

**Step 2:** Both adjectives add information about the same beast.

**Final Answer: E — but also.**

**17. \_\_\_ I won't be able to attend the birthday party.**

**Step 1:** Choose a polite introductory expression for unwelcome information.

**Step 2:** I am afraid softens the refusal.

**Final Answer: D — I am afraid.**

**18. Neither John \_\_\_ Mary sat for the mock examination.**

**Step 1:** The negative pair is neither ... nor.

**Step 2:** Or belongs to either ... or instead.

**Final Answer: C — nor.**

**19. Change He said that he was watering the flowers into direct speech.**

**Step 1:** Restore the speaker's own pronoun I.

**Step 2:** In the usual reported-speech conversion, was watering is the backshift of am watering.

**Final Answer: C — He said, "I am watering the flowers."**

**20. Add a question tag: He is a Standard Seven pupil.**

**Step 1:** A positive statement takes a negative tag.

**Step 2:** Repeat the auxiliary is and subject he: isn't he?

**Final Answer: B — isn't he?**

**21. Reply positively to Excuse me, sir, may I come in?**

**Step 1:** May asks for permission.

**Step 2:** Grant permission with the same auxiliary: Yes, you may.

**Final Answer: E — Yes, you may.**

**22. We prefer eating rice \_\_\_ potatoes.**

**Step 1:** Use the construction prefer X to Y.

**Step 2:** To introduces the less-preferred alternative.

**Final Answer: A — to.**

**23. Children without a balanced diet become \_\_\_\_.**

**Step 1:** The context describes a harmful consequence.

**Step 2:** Add un- to healthy to form the appropriate opposite.

**Final Answer: E — unhealthy.**

**24. Cooks who are \_\_\_\_ have many burn marks.**

**Step 1:** After are, an adjective describes the cooks.

**Step 2:** Careless means not taking enough care; it fits the stated accidents.

**Final Answer: A — careless.**

**25. Nina is the \_\_\_\_ of the two intelligent girls.**

**Step 1:** A comparison of two people uses a comparative.

**Step 2:** For intelligent, form the comparative with more.

**Final Answer: B — more intelligent.**

**26. Breaking off a relationship means deciding to \_\_\_\_ it.**

**Step 1:** Break off means discontinue something.

**Step 2:** The matching verb is end.

**Final Answer: D — end.**

**27. What word is closest to instructions?**

**Step 1:** Instructions tell someone what to do and how to do it.

**Step 2:** Directions is the closest word in this context.

**Final Answer: C — directions.**

**28. Give the opposite of clean.**

**Step 1:** Clean means free from dirt.

**Step 2:** Its direct opposite is dirty.

**Final Answer: D — dirty.**

**29. A chameleon does not move fast; it walks \_\_\_\_.**

**Step 1:** The blank describes how the animal walks, so use an adverb.

**Step 2:** The opposite of quickly is slowly.

**Final Answer: E — slowly.**

**30. Bad pupils \_\_\_\_ their teachers, unlike good pupils who respect them.**

**Step 1:** Choose a verb opposite in meaning to respect.

**Step 2:** Disrespect means fail to show respect.

**Final Answer: A — disrespect.**

**31. At her birthday celebration, my sister has dressed \_\_\_\_.**

**Step 1:** The blank describes the manner of dressing.

**Step 2:** Smartly is the adverb expressing a neat appearance.

**Final Answer: C — smartly.**

**32. There are \_\_\_\_ oranges left in the fridge.**

**Step 1:** Oranges is a plural countable noun.

**Step 2:** Few is used with plural countable things and is the intended quantifier here.

**Final Answer: E — few.**

Study Tip: More can also form a grammatical sentence in a comparison context, but few is NECTA's expected answer for this item.

**33. A farmer tills the soil using \_\_\_\_.**

**Step 1:** Tilling means loosening and turning the soil.

**Step 2:** A hoe is the agricultural tool intended in the options.

**Final Answer: C — a hoe.**

**34. Besides jewellery, ring can refer to the sound of what?**

**Step 1:** Ring has more than one meaning.

**Step 2:** A bell rings; its ringing sound is also called a ring.

**Final Answer: C — a bell.**

**35. Kaunda cut \_\_\_ with a knife.**

**Step 1:** The subject and injured person are the same male person.

**Step 2:** Use the reflexive pronoun himself.

**Final Answer: E — himself.**

Section Summary: Notice tense markers, subject agreement and fixed expressions. Check whether the blank requires a verb, adjective, adverb or pronoun.

## Section B — Composition

**36. Order the sentence: At the end, each team had one goal.**

**Step 1:** Introduce the match before recounting its goals.

**Step 2:** The phrase at the end concludes the composition, so this sentence is fifth.

**Final Answer: E — Fifth sentence.**

**37. Order the sentence: Dogo boys scored first in the first half.**

**Step 1:** The match introduction comes first.

**Step 2:** The first goal is the next event, before the equalising goal.

**Final Answer: B — Second sentence.**

**38. Order the sentence: There was a match between Dogo boys and Goma boys.**

**Step 1:** A composition first introduces the event and participants.

**Step 2:** This sentence supplies that opening information.

**Final Answer: A — First sentence.**

**39. Order the sentence: Both teams played tirelessly as time was nearly over.**

**Step 1:** This happens after the first-half goal and second-half equaliser.

**Step 2:** It precedes the final result.

**Final Answer: D — Fourth sentence.**

**40. Order the sentence: Goma boys equalised in the second half.**

**Step 1:** The first-half goal must come before the second-half equaliser.

**Step 2:** This is followed by the final effort and result.

**Final Answer: C — Third sentence.**

Section Summary: The complete order is 38 → 37 → 40 → 39 → 36: introduction, first goal, equaliser, final effort, result.

## Section C — Comprehension

**41. What was Mr Kikuko's occupation?**

**Step 1:** The passage says he made furniture.

**Step 2:** A person who makes furniture from wood is a carpenter.

**Final Answer: He was a carpenter.**

**42. Why did Mbuto engage in child labour?**

**Step 1:** His father died and his mother could no longer work.

**Step 2:** He was the eldest child and had to seek money for the household.

**Final Answer: He worked to support his family after his father died and his mother became too ill to work.**

**43. Why did Mbuto cry after breaking his leg?**

**Step 1:** Look beyond physical pain to the fear stated in the passage.

**Step 2:** He knew the injury could prevent him from providing for his family.

**Final Answer: He was in pain and feared he could no longer support his family.**

#### 44. Why did Mbuto work in the mine instead of attending school?

**Step 1:** He had left school to earn a living for his family.

**Step 2:** Selling on the street did not provide enough money, so he sought paid work at the mine.

**Final Answer: His family needed income, and street sales were insufficient, so he took a mining job.**

#### 45. What enabled Mbuto to return to school?

**Step 1:** Identify the person who offered help after his injury.

**Step 2:** A nurse promised to care for his family and arrange his return to education.

**Final Answer: A nurse's support for his family enabled him to return to school.**

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Section Summary: Use facts from the passage and answer the exact question. Causes, motives and consequences may require different sentences.

#### Source Checks

NECTA: PSLE 2023 English analysis and listening passage